

Explorer Sheet

Name _____

1 · Picture Words

These are real kanji — Japanese picture-words. Look for the picture hiding in each one, then trace the two gray copies. Go slowly, top to bottom and left to right.

山
MOUNTAIN
three peaks

山 山

川
RIVER
water flowing down

川 川

日
SUN
the sun in the sky

日 日

木
TREE
trunk, branches, roots

木 木

火
FIRE
a flame with sparks

火 火

人
PERSON
two legs walking

人 人

Then, on your own paper: invent a kanji of your own for *rain*, *cat* and *happy*. Be ready to say why you drew it that way.

2 · My Haiku

Three lines: **5 beats, 7 beats, 5 beats**. Clap as you say each word. One box per beat. Write about islands, a volcano, snow, a fast train, a red gate, or an ocean wave.

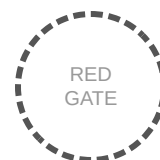
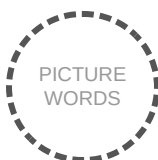
Line 1 — five

Line 2 — seven

Line 3 — five

3 · Explorer Stamps

Color in a circle every time you finish a station. Six circles and you have earned the badge.



Everything else happens on the screen and on plain paper. Read each station at wonderschool.vercel.app → 2nd grade → Japan, and do your drawing — the map, Mount Fuji in three seasons, your game character, the torii gate — on blank paper, as big as you like.

Country Cards — 1 of 2

✂ Cut along the card borders

JAPAN

EAST ASIA · ISLAND NATION

PEOPLE **122.7M** #11LAND **377,975 km²** #62ECONOMY **\$4.38T** #4EC. FREEDOM **70.3** #30

14,125 islands. Two-thirds forest. Builds about 45% of the world's industrial robots.

UNITED STATES

NORTH AMERICA

PEOPLE **341.8M** #3LAND **9,525,067 km²** #4ECONOMY **\$32.38T** #1EC. FREEDOM **72.8** #22

Biggest economy on Earth — bigger than #2 and #3 added together.

CHINA

EAST ASIA

PEOPLE **1,404.9M** #2LAND **9,596,960 km²** #3ECONOMY **\$20.85T** #2EC. FREEDOM **48.3** #154

Huge on three categories, near the bottom on the fourth. That gap is the whole story.

INDIA

SOUTH ASIA

PEOPLE **1,429.4M** #1LAND **3,287,263 km²** #7ECONOMY **\$4.15T** #6EC. FREEDOM **52.5** #132

Most people of any country — and 11 times more people than Japan for a similar-sized economy.

GERMANY

WESTERN EUROPE

PEOPLE **83.5M** #19LAND **357,581 km²** #63ECONOMY **\$5.45T** #3EC. FREEDOM **71.7** #24

Almost exactly Japan's size in land, but with 39 million fewer people.

UNITED KINGDOM

WESTERN EUROPE · ISLAND NATION

PEOPLE **69.5M** #23LAND **244,376 km²** #78ECONOMY **\$4.26T** #5EC. FREEDOM **70.4** #29

Japan's closest rival on three of four categories. The #4/#5 spots swap around by the year.

✂ Cut along the card borders.

Country Cards — 2 of 2

✂ Cut along the card borders

FRANCE

WESTERN EUROPE

PEOPLE	69.1M #24
LAND	643,801 km² #42
ECONOMY	\$3.60T #7
EC. FREEDOM	64.6 #65

Includes overseas territories, which is why the land number is bigger than you expect.

ITALY

SOUTHERN EUROPE

PEOPLE	58.9M #28
LAND	302,068 km² #71
ECONOMY	\$2.74T #8
EC. FREEDOM	63.3 #73

A weak card in this deck — solid on Economy, beatable on everything else.

BRAZIL

SOUTH AMERICA

PEOPLE	214.2M #7
LAND	8,510,346 km² #5
ECONOMY	\$2.64T #10
EC. FREEDOM	52.4 #134

Huge land, lots of people, and an economy smaller than Japan's — with 91 million MORE people.

SOUTH KOREA

EAST ASIA · JAPAN'S NEIGHBOUR

PEOPLE	51.1M #34
LAND	100,432 km² #107
ECONOMY	\$1.93T #15
EC. FREEDOM	73.7 #19

A quarter of Japan's land, and it beats Japan on economic freedom.

CANADA

NORTH AMERICA

PEOPLE	41.4M #39
LAND	9,984,670 km² #2
ECONOMY	\$2.51T #11
EC. FREEDOM	75.6 #14

26 times Japan's land area — and one third of Japan's population.

AUSTRALIA

OCEANIA · ISLAND CONTINENT

PEOPLE	27.8M #54
LAND	7,741,220 km² #6
ECONOMY	\$2.12T #12
EC. FREEDOM	80.1 #4

Fewest people in the deck, and the only card here rated fully "Free" on economic freedom.

Role cards

✂ Cut along the borders · one card each

GRADES 2–3

The Illustrator

You own everything anyone can see. You decide the layout — which means you decide how much room everyone else gets.

- Draw Japan: four big islands in a curve, tiny dots all around.
- Draw a torii gate and Mount Fuji somewhere on the chart.
- Write headings in kanji where you know one: 山 mountain, 川 river, 日 sun, 人 person.
- Write a haiku across the top. Five beats, seven beats, five beats.
- You draw **first**, alone, for five minutes. Nobody else touches the paper.

YOUR POWER

If someone wants more space they have to ask you. You can say no.

GRADES 3–4

The Quartermaster

You run the Country Cards deck. No number reaches the wall chart except through you.

- Deal the cards. Find **three categories where Japan beats the USA**.
- Find **three where Japan loses**.
- Hand each one to the Fact-checker on a slip with the category written on it.
- Work in a pair with the Fact-checker. Expect arguments.

YOUR POWER

The Analyst cannot write the verdict until you have delivered four approved numbers. They have to wait for you.

GRADES 4–5

The Fact-checker

Nothing goes on the chart without a source written next to it. Not the drawings — the claims.

- For every number, write down where it came from and what year it is from.
- If nobody can say where a number came from, cross it out. It does not go up.
- Catch at least one claim somebody assumed instead of checking.

YOUR POWER

A veto over everyone, including the oldest person at the table. Use it at least twice or you are not doing the job.

GRADES 5–6

The Analyst

You write the verdict at the bottom of the chart. Two sentences, and a third that argues against you.

- **Sentence 1:** is Japan a **rich** country? Commit — no "it depends".
- **Sentence 2:** is Japan a **free** country? Same rule.
- **Sentence 3:** the strongest argument that you are wrong.
- You may only use numbers the Fact-checker approved.

YOUR POWER

None. You have to persuade the Illustrator for space and wait for the Quartermaster's numbers. That is the job.

Challenge round, last five minutes. The teacher asks questions and anyone may answer. A correct answer from the **youngest** student is worth three points; from the oldest, one point. · Full instructions and timing: wonderschool.vercel.app/together/